

The Tale of the Squeaky Saloon

Cowboy story • 3-4 years old



Part 1: The Squeaky Saloon Door

In the dusty town of Sunny Creek, there was a little saloon with a big problem. The door squeaked and creaked every time it opened. « **Squeak, squeak!** » it went, making everyone giggle. But Sheriff Sam knew it was time to fix it.

Sheriff Sam was brave and kind. He wore a shiny badge and a big hat. One sunny morning, he decided to explore the town to find some oil for the door. « **I need to make the door quiet,** » he said with a smile.

As he walked, Sheriff Sam waved at the townsfolk. « **Howdy, Sheriff!** » they called out. He passed the general store, the bakery, and even the blacksmith's shop. But none of them had the oil he needed.

Part 2: A Friendly Help

Sheriff Sam stopped by the big barn at the end of town. Inside, he met Farmer Joe. « **Howdy, Sheriff!** » said Farmer Joe. « **What brings you here?** »

« **I'm looking for some oil to fix the squeaky saloon door,** » said Sheriff Sam.

Farmer Joe smiled. « **I might have just what you need!** » He pulled out a small bottle of oil. « **This should do the trick.** »

« **Thank you!** » said Sheriff Sam, feeling happy. He hurried back to the saloon, with the bottle of oil in his hand.

Part 3: The Quiet Door

Back at the saloon, Sheriff Sam carefully oiled the hinges. « **Drip, drip,** » went the oil. He opened the door slowly. It didn't squeak at all! The door was quiet and

smooth.

« **Hooray!** » cheered all the people in the saloon. Sheriff Sam smiled wide, feeling proud. Now, everyone could come and go without a squeak.

« **Thank you, Sheriff Sam!** » they all said. Sheriff Sam tipped his hat and said, « **Just doing my job.** »

And from that day on, the saloon door opened quietly, and Sunny Creek was filled with laughter and happiness. Sheriff Sam knew that sometimes, even the smallest jobs can make a big difference.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who fixed the saloon door?

- Sheriff Sam
- Farmer Joe
- The baker
- The blacksmith

2) What sound did the door make?

- Squeak squeak
- Bang bang
- Ring ring
- Splash splash

3) Who gave Sheriff Sam the oil?

- The teacher
- Farmer Joe
- The dog
- The mayor

4) What happened after the door was oiled?

- It stayed noisy
- It flew away
- It was quiet
- It turned red

Correct answers:

1) Sheriff Sam 2) Squeak squeak 3) Farmer Joe 4) It was quiet

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Dusty: Covered with fine dirt that makes things look old.

Saloon: A simple place where people meet to talk and drink.

Squeaked: Made a short, high sound when something moved.

Creaked: Made a long, low sound when something moved.

Hinges: Metal parts that let a door open and close.

Oil: A smooth liquid used to make things move quietly.

Oiled: Put oil on something so it moves without noise.

Shiny badge: A small, bright piece of metal someone wears to show a job.

Blacksmith's: The place where a person makes things from hot metal.

Barn: A big building on a farm where animals or tools stay.